PROSPER AWUNI

Senior SOC Analyst | Detection Engineering, Threat Hunting and Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Analyst with over five years of experience in detection engineering, threat hunting, incident response leadership, and security automation in complex enterprise environments. I operate at the senior technical level, focusing on building and refining detection logic, hunting for adversary activity across hybrid cloud and on-premises estates, and leading incident investigations through to resolution. I have deep hands-on experience with Microsoft Sentinel (using Kusto Query Language (KQL)), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platforms, along with scripting and automation in PowerShell to streamline security operations. I am not a traditional tier-1 alert handler; I bring engineering discipline to detection and a structured, evidence-based approach to threat hunting and incident leadership. I am seeking a permanent remote-first role where I can apply this depth to uplift detection capability and drive measurable security outcomes.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering and SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rule authoring, alert tuning, threat use-case development
- **Threat Hunting:** Hypothesis-driven and indicator-based hunting across endpoint, identity, and network telemetry; CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, incident leadership, containment and eradication, root cause analysis, post-incident review
- **Security Automation and SOAR:** Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, PowerShell scripting, automated triage and enrichment workflows
- **EDR and XDR Platforms:** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender (M365D)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Identity and Access:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security controls, cloud workload protection, hybrid cloud environments
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (NIST CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Additional Tools:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony, Tanium, Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2022 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Lead detection engineering across the university's Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, authoring and iteratively refining MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM to surface high-fidelity alerts across a 8,000-user, hybrid cloud estate.
- Conduct structured, hypothesis-driven threat hunting campaigns using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Microsoft Sentinel telemetry, investigating adversary behaviours across endpoint, identity, email, and network domains.
- Lead incident response activities end-to-end using the NIST 800-61 lifecycle, acting as the technical incident commander for high-severity events, coordinating containment, eradication, and recovery, and producing post-incident reviews with actionable detection improvements.
- Develop Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks and PowerShell automation scripts to accelerate alert enrichment, threat indicator lookups, and routine containment actions, reducing manual analyst

effort on repeatable tasks.

- Manage the university's Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) estate across CrowdStrike Falcon, MDE, and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), tuning sensor configurations, prevention policies, and alert thresholds to balance protection and operational noise.
- Oversee the vulnerability management programme (Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)), prioritising findings by risk and tracking remediation through to closure with IT and application teams.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, enforcing least-privilege access, Conditional Access controls, and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) to reduce identity attack surface.
- Contribute to security architecture decisions, reviewing new system designs and third-party integrations against the university's risk appetite and applicable frameworks (ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus).

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Authored and tuned detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, developing use cases for identity-based attacks, ransomware precursors, lateral movement, and data exfiltration across a hybrid cloud environment.
- Performed threat hunting across endpoint, identity, and cloud telemetry using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Defender, proactively surfacing indicators of compromise and attack that evaded automated detections.
- Responded to and led investigation of security incidents aligned with NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, escalating findings and driving remediation with infrastructure and application owners.
- Deployed and configured CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across the university estate, ensuring consistent endpoint visibility and enforcing prevention policies at scale.
- Supported the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), extending detection coverage to on-premises Active Directory and Azure AD identity signals across 8,000 users.
- Built SOAR automation workflows to auto-enrich alerts with threat intelligence, reducing mean time to triage for common alert types and enabling analysts to focus on higher-complexity investigations.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, delivering risk-prioritised remediation reports to IT teams and tracking progress against agreed service level agreements.
- Supported ISO 27001 alignment and Cyber Essentials Plus certification activities, contributing evidence for security controls and working with governance teams on audit preparation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed security operations and infrastructure for a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech platform, applying CIS Controls and ISO 27001 security controls to protect cloud-hosted, multi-tenant environments and customer data.
- Monitored security event logs and alerts, investigating anomalies and escalating incidents for containment and remediation in line with internal incident response procedures.
- Performed security quality assurance for product releases, identifying security defects and working with development teams to ensure fixes met defined acceptance criteria before deployment.
- Administered endpoint protection, cloud identity management (Azure AD), and network security controls, enforcing least-privilege access and monitoring for policy violations.
- Managed device lifecycle, compliance policies, and secure configuration via Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM), and Mobile Application Management (MAM) across corporate and remote devices.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a comprehensive library of MITRE ATT&CK-mapped detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel (KQL) covering credential access, lateral movement, persistence, and exfiltration techniques, raising the detection maturity of the university's security operations function.
- Established a formal threat hunting programme, running monthly hypothesis-driven campaigns across CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel telemetry; identified and remediated previously undetected threat activity on multiple occasions.

- Developed SOAR automation playbooks for alert enrichment and triage, reducing manual handling time for high-volume, lower-severity alert categories and enabling faster escalation of genuine threats.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/Prevent to over 8,000 endpoints across a geographically dispersed university estate, delivering full endpoint visibility and enabling detection and prevention capability at enterprise scale.
- Led the university's Microsoft 365 security uplift, deploying Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) for 8,000 users, integrating signals into Microsoft Sentinel for correlated, cross-domain threat detection.
- Supported successful Cyber Essentials Plus certification, ensuring the organisation met the government-endorsed standard for baseline security controls across the full technology estate.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Remote (UK)